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Subject: Lead Data Scientist

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am writing to express my enthusiastic interest in the Lead Data Scientist position at AbsenceSoft. With a proven track record of leading teams and delivering high-impact, enterprise-grade machine learning models, I am confident that my skills and experience align perfectly with the requirements of this role and AbsenceSoft's mission to elevate the leave and accommodations experience.

The job description emphasizes the need for a leader who can translate business challenges into intelligent, scalable models. In my role as Lead Data Scientist at Caterpillar, I spearheaded the development of an AI-based system that estimated equipment repair times, directly addressing a significant business challenge and resulting in an \$80M reduction in warranty costs. This project, which earned a CEO Award, involved leading the end-to-end lifecycle of the model, from scoping and data preparation to deployment and monitoring—a process I am passionate about and prepared to lead at AbsenceSoft.

Your posting highlights a need for deep expertise in advanced LLM engineering and transformer architectures. My hands-on experience with frameworks like TensorFlow, PyTorch, and HuggingFace has been central to my work. I have designed and deployed complex NLP solutions and am adept at the sophisticated techniques required for building, fine-tuning, and evaluating large language models. I am particularly excited by the opportunity to apply these advanced skills to solve the high-value, real-world problems in the compliance, leave, and workforce intelligence domains at AbsenceSoft.

Furthermore, I have extensive experience collaborating with MLOps and engineering teams to productionize models in robust, scalable environments. I have designed and deployed automated MLOps pipelines using AWS SageMaker, Step Functions, and Snowflake, ensuring that models are not only accurate but also maintainable and efficient in production. My background in managing the full model lifecycle, from development to monitoring for drift, has prepared me to own the model evaluation framework and uphold the principles of Responsible AI that are critical to your work.

My career has been dedicated to leveraging data science to create substantial value and drive strategic initiatives. I am a hands-on, strategic leader who is eager to contribute to your team, mentor junior data scientists, and help shape the scientific and strategic direction for your modeling road map.

Thank you for considering my application. I have attached my resume for your review and welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience can make a significant impact at AbsenceSoft.

Best regards,

Todd Takala

Attachment: CV